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Digital Literacy Competencies among the Indigenous PG Students in the Selected Universities of South Bengal

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ABSTRACT

Students at universities now rely heavily on the Internet for information. Research consistently demonstrates that many students lack the digital information literacy abilities necessary to locate and assess content on the internet. This paper investigates the digital information literacy skills and competencies of the Indigenous postgraduate students of four universities in the southern part of West Bengal, India. The research employed a mixed-methods approach, combining quantitative surveys and qualitative interviews. A structured questionnaire was administered to a purposive sample of 260 indigenous PG students across selected public universities in South Bengal. The study finds that most Indigenous students recognize their information needs. Still, only 24.35 % of the students don't have adequate knowledge of how to find the exact information from the internet, and above 50 % students don't have knowledge of different search techniques. Only 19.13 % students can distinguish between the various online information sources that are available, such as scholarly or popular, current or historical, etc. The Digital Information Literacy (DIL) skills of these Indigenous students in all four universities were unsatisfactory. The current study emphasizes that DIL skills are essential for university-level students for their studies and also for everyday living. This research contributes original insights into a relatively underexplored population-indigenous postgraduate students in South Bengal, highlighting the digital divide within higher education. It provides a foundational understanding for educators, policymakers, and institutions aiming to foster digital equity in academic settings.

Keywords: Information literacy; Digital literacy; Indigenous students; Post graduate students; Academic library; Tribal students

1. INTRODUCTION

World Wide Web was launched in the year 1991[1], after that, digital information has proliferated globally, because of the growth of computer, mobile, and internet technology. Adequate digital content is available in the present day. The significance of digital literacy and abilities has grown in the twenty-first century. UNESCO Institute for Statistics[2] defines digital literacy as, "Digital literacy is the ability to access, manage, understand, integrate, communicate, evaluate and create information safely and appropriately through digital technologies for employment, decent jobs, and entrepreneurship. It includes competences that are variously referred to as computer literacy, ICT literacy, information literacy, and media literacy". Information is available in a variety and quantity that is beyond comprehension. It is not just in large quantities but also in varying degrees of quality and is accessible through many media. Increasing the use of digital tools is the only approach to address these problems.[3] Digital literacy encompasses the ability to access, manage, evaluate, integrate, create, and communicate information in a networked, computer-supported, web-based environment, either individually or cooperatively. The modern generation needs to be digitally literate to interact with the digital world[4].

The higher education sector is still facing challenges due to the slow pace of growth of digital information literacy compared to advancements in information and communication technology[5]. Since the advent of online, remote, and e-learning, among other methods, information and communication technology has been employed extensively in the higher education sector for teaching and learning purposes. Academic libraries serve as the foundation of the educational system, providing access to electronic and digital resources, courseware, and collections for e-learning. To better serve end users, librarians are adjusting to the constantly changing trends more effectively. A brief review shows that the publishing system, libraries, education system, publications and knowledge transmission have all been impacted by the advancements brought about by ICT and other supporting technologies[6]. Indigenous postgraduate students encounter particular difficulties and advantages when pursuing higher education. Many

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of them are driven to overcome obstacles and pursue postgraduate degrees even though their communities frequently have socioeconomic inequities and restricted access to resources.

For several years, the term "indigenous" has been the most widely used. 'Tribes', 'First Peoples/Nations', 'Aboriginals', 'ethnic groups', 'Adivasi' and 'Janjati' are some alternative terms that might be preferred in various nations. Hunter-gatherers, nomads, peasants, hill people, and other occupational and geographic designations are also used identical with "indigenous peoples."[7] Indigenous students belong to a variety of cultural groups, speak inheritance languages, and are citizens of sovereign nations[8].

ALA's Digital Literacy Task Force[9] defines digital literacy as "the ability to use information and communication technologies to find, evaluate, create, and communicate information, requiring both cognitive and technical skills."

According to ACRL[10] (ALA, Information Literacy Competency Standards for Higher Education) Academic libraries prioritize information literacy above digital literacy, however there is a close connection between these two 21st-century literacies. Digital literacy is necessary for information literacy to access relevant online research sources, and information literacy provides additional context for the assessment abilities that digital literacy develops.

2. LITERATURE REVIEW

The availability of e-resources in university libraries is crucial in enabling users to quickly and easily obtain the information they need. In actuality, electronic information resources have become indispensable in the educational setting[11]. In 1974, in a paper presented at the National Commission for Libraries and Information Science, Paul Zurkowski first used the phrase "information literacy." He underlined that to thrive and compete in the rapidly developing information society; people must be information-literate[12]. The list of abilities and information needed for DIL has grown significantly, now encompassing media, computer, network and ICT literacy. Additional notions that have surfaced as expansions of the digital information literacy idea include digital literacy, digital fluency, data literacy, mobile literacy and Internet literacy[13-14]. It must be noted that ICT could be important for the long-term preservation, sharing, archiving and management of indigenous knowledge[15]. However, to ensure that these initiatives benefit both the greater community and the indigenous communities that possess the necessary knowledge.

A study was carried out on the students at the Central University of Tamilnadu and the study presented data showing that most of the pupils have a solid comprehension of digital tools and how to use them. The survey also showed that the pupils' proficiency with digital literacy is excellent. Interestingly, despite their skill, they seemed to prefer reading print books over other types. This implies that even if kids show proficiency in digital literacy, they still strongly favor reading print books. These results demonstrate that students who responded to the survey both preferred conventional print materials and had a working knowledge of digital literacy[16]. Another study was conducted on the postgraduate students of their digital information literacy skills and stated that a maximum number of the students are familiar with digital resources. To satisfy their information needs and/or obtain up-to-date information, pupils should also be made aware of digital information resources[17]. Khan, Arif[18], *et al.* carried out a study on the visually challenged teachers to know their information literacy skills and found that to help the underprivileged community benefit from information literacy abilities, planners and experts can use the results to include IFLA's E8 model of information literacy into many courses offered at the blind schools. Oseghale[19] conducted a study on humanities students and found that a high degree of digital information literacy proficiency in terms of using digital devices, completing web-based tasks, and locating and evaluating information, but a low level in terms of using e-books. The study also suggested that everyone can make use of the opportunities presented by the information age; proactive measures should be made to raise knowledge of e-resources, assist and teach others, maintain subscriptions to e-resources, and enhance the amount of local content available.

According to Mamtora[20], *et al.* by providing information literacy training and support, academic libraries make free from doubt that students have the skills and knowledge necessary to fully benefit from their university education. These programs of actively and completely engaging with Indigenous pupils have resulted in significant advancements. Badke[6]; Kandiuk[21], opined that to eliminate structural impediments to the full use of library resources, services and facilities, as well as to address biases, it is recommended that diversity and inclusion concepts be incorporated into formal library publications. The Library and Information Service is susceptible to losing momentum as a result of staff and budget changes in the absence of formalization. Self-directed learning is linked to digital literacy.

Hung[22], *et al.* stated that this indicates the capacity of students to recognize their learning requirements and to assume ownership of their education, for instance, by planning their studies, choosing their sources and asking for assistance. A study carried out on the students of anatomy and physiology courses finds that for academic achievement in online courses, some components of digital literacy are more important than others. Higher levels of digital literacy were demonstrated by students with backgrounds in natural science, highlighting the significance of taking prior learning into account when assisting students in developing their digital abilities in online courses. Students were adept at evaluating their digital literacy, which made it simple to measure the class's overall digital literacy and allow for focused interventions for all students[23].

Students must be able to use and understand analytical and evaluative abilities; thus, information literacy education

is crucial because it helps them recognize what they have learned and gives them a way to reflect on their learning and knowledge. In other words, information literacy instruction has the power to change the educational process such that students can pursue self-directed learning throughout their lives outside of the formal curriculum[24].

The number of Indigenous peoples is rapidly increasing in many nations, but, because of a variety of political and socioeconomic factors, the majority of them, especially those residing in rural areas have experienced ongoing academic difficulties[25]. The well-being of indigenous populations and sustainable development depend heavily on the indigenous knowledge systems that constitute a significant portion of India's cultural heritage. India's indigenous knowledge systems are evident in the people's comprehensive grasp of their local environs, all-encompassing worldview, and dedication to group decision-making and the preservation of their cultures.

The review of the literature shows that, to date, the digital information literacy of postgraduate students from indigenous communities in developing countries, particularly India, has not received much attention. In addition to filling a gap in the literature, this study attempts to represent the digital information literacy skills and competencies of postgraduate Indigenous students.

3. SIGNIFICANCE OF THE STUDY

Digital Information Literacy also aims to teach students how to find and access information from the Web and prepare them for lifelong learning. Learners can always locate the data they need to complete a task or make a choice. It supports students' growth as more independent learners, research growth, and enhanced control of their education. Building lifelong skills and ensuring students' continuing growth in their careers should be the main goals of educational institutions[26]. Several studies have shown that many users primarily indigenous students of academic libraries have inadequate knowledge to use the information resources effectively because they lack the necessary information access skills. When providing literary information to their patrons, academic libraries should take their patrons' preferences into account[27-28].

After overcoming numerous obstacles to gain access to higher education, Indigenous students require appropriate information literacy training to locate, recognize, assess, and utilize information in various formats to create content for social, cultural, or personal purposes. Extensive research is necessary for post-graduate courses, and this frequently entails using databases, digital archives, and scholarly periodicals. Limited access to digital materials and technology is a problem for many Indigenous communities. Gaining digital information literacy abilities assures that Indigenous post-graduate students can use and understand online research tools, academic resources, and educational platforms that might not otherwise be available to them. Indigenous students require digital information literacy abilities to locate, analyse, and critically examine sources. Indigenous students can support Indigenous rights, causes, and policies and participate in social justice campaigns by using digital information literacy.

4. OBJECTIVES OF THE STUDY

- To evaluate the level of digital information literacy skills of the Indigenous postgraduate students of four Universities.
- To investigate the status of e-resources utilisation by Indigenous postgraduate students of four Universities.
- To identify the challenges of e-resources utilisation by the Indigenous post-graduate students.

5. SCOPE AND COVERAGE

Only postgraduate students from Indigenous backgrounds are included in this study. We are taking those universities which are at least 10 years old. Vidyasagar University of Paschim Medinipur District, Bankura University of Bankura District, Sidho-Kanho-Birsa University of Purulia District and Kazi Nazrul University of Paschim Bardhaman District are taken for the study. These four districts are the most Indigenous-populated districts of West Bengal, in India. According to the Census of India 2011 data, Paschim Medinipur, Bankura, Purulia and Bardhaman have 16.6 %, 7 %, 10.2 %, and 9.2 % of the Indigenous people living among the total Indigenous population of West Bengal respectively. The questionnaire was distributed to only that sample of Indigenous PG students who are enrolled in the different postgraduate programs in these four Universities.

5.1 Vidyasagar University (VU)

Vidyasagar University started its journey in the year 1981 at Paschim Medinipur District of West Bengal. Growing out of a long cultural and educational movement in West Bengal in general and in the undivided district of Midnapore in particular, Vidyasagar University bears the name of one of the most illustrious sons of Bengal and one of the doyens of the Indian Renaissance, Pandit Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar. Many groups, most notably the Regional Education Association, Midnapore, led by Professor A.K. Gayen of IIT, Kharagpur, had proposed the concept of establishing a university in the district. On July 18, 1983, the late B.D. Pande, the governor of West Bengal and the university's distinguished chancellor at the time, laid the foundation stone for the main campus at Tantigaria mouza in Midnapore Sadar Town[29].

5.2 Bankura University (BKU)

Bankura, which was once known as Mallabhum, is rightfully proud of its extensive legacy of exceptional traditional culture. It is seen in the works of Jamini Roy and Ramkinkar Bej, the temple town of Bishnupur, the traditional Dokra art, and the creative and intellectual prowess of the renowned eighteenth-century mathematician Subhankari Arya. Bankura University was founded in the year 2013 in one of the socioeconomically underprivileged

districts, Bankura of West Bengal. The university started with 13 postgraduate departments. The knowledge systems in language, literature, cultural studies, social sciences, and other scientific fields shall be preserved and strengthened at Bankura University[30].

5.3 Sidhu Kanho Birsha University (SKBU)

Sidho-Kanho-Birsha University is located in the Purulia district, which is well-known for the native Indigenous dance known as "Chhau Dance". The university was established by West Bengal ACT XII of 2010 and is fully supported by the West Bengal government. The main aim of the University is to promote higher education in a range of academic subjects, with an emphasis on the study of indigenous languages, cultures, and rural development. The University currently operates 28 postgraduate departments in total[31].

5.4 Kazi Nazrul University (KNU)

Kazi Nazrul University was established in the year 2012 under the West Bengal Act XIX of 2012, named in honor of Indian rebel poet Kazi Nazrul Islam (1899–1976). Kazi Nazrul, the revolutionary poet, is ingrained in Bengali cultural memory due to his unwavering quest for an independent spirit and his awareness of the syncretism inherent in knowledge traditions and transactions. Bengali, English, History and Mathematics are the four main subjects in which postgraduate sessions were started by the university in July 2013. Kazi Nazrul University is located in the Damodar River Valley and has historically been surrounded by the coal mines and industries of the city of Asansol. However, the university's mission extends beyond providing a comprehensive education for students wishing to pursue jobs in the humanities, general sciences, commerce, and law[32].

6. METHODOLOGY

After performing a thorough literature analysis and considering the study's objectives, we considered the survey method to perform this study, and a structured questionnaire was created. The questionnaire was then distributed to the Indigenous postgraduate students of the four Universities. Total intake capacity of indigenous students of four universities for two year post graduate courses was 146 for VU, 60 for BKU, 130 for SKBU and 59 For KNU in each year respectively. So total number of indigenous students for two years is 795. By using Cochran's formula, the sample size for this study became 260. So total of 260 questionnaires were distributed among the Indigenous postgraduate students in such a way that all the departments were covered and 230 were received. To properly examine the data, the information gathered from the respondents was tabulated, and a simple percentage analysis was used. For this purpose, we used Microsoft Excel. It is significant to remember that the study's conclusions are entirely dependent on the input provided by the participating students. The veracity and accuracy of the data supplied by the respondents determine the accuracy and dependability of the findings. The study aimed to offer significant insights into the students' digital information literacy abilities by employing the survey method and assessing the collected data.

7. RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

Postgraduate students are expected to be aware of the services offered by the University library, as well as its policies regarding the collection and usage of various information resources[33]. This is because of their educational background. Following this platform is necessary to make the most of the library and its resources. Here we examine the digital information literacy level of the Indigenous postgraduate students of four Universities in the southern part of West Bengal.

7.1 Demographic Information

The questionnaire was received from 230 students, from Table 1 total of 105 are male and 125 are female students.

7.2 Knowledge of ICT and Internet of Indigenous Students

This section examines the ICT proficiency of Indigenous postgraduate students. A five-point rating scale is being utilized to measure the numerous statements in this study. Table 2 depicts that the majority of the Indigenous students know basic computer operations. 49.13% of the students are unfamiliar with the various interrogative searching techniques. URL was unfamiliar to a majority of the Indigenous students 54.78 %. The majority of students do not even know how to safeguard digital devices from viruses and threats.

7.3 Ability to Search Documents Available on the Internet

Table 3 indicates that all of the Indigenous postgraduate students at the four universities use basic search methods to find information online. Only a small percentage of students from the four Universities are familiar with the advanced search and exact match techniques. 47.69 % of respondents from VU and 55.56 % of respondents from

Table 1. Gender-wise distribution of the respondents

University name	No. of respondent	Male	Female	%
Vidyasagar University(VU)	65	35	30	28.26
Bankura University(BKU)	60	25	35	26.09
Sidho-Kanho-Birsha University(SKBU)	60	27	33	26.09
Kazi Nazrul University(KNU)	45	18	27	19.56
Total respondent	**230**	**105**	**125**	**100**

KNU know field search techniques. A maximum number of Indigenous students from the four universities don't know advanced search techniques. None of the respondents from the four Universities don't know how to use truncation, wildcards or controlled vocabulary when searching.

7.4 E-Resources Accessed by Indigenous Students

Four universities have their own e-resource subscriptions. Out of these, SKBU has only a few subscribed e-journals and e-books but no e-database and no institutional repository. But Vidyasagar University, Kazi Nazrul University and Bankura University have e-databases and institutional repositories. Table 4 depicts that most BKU and SKBU students lack knowledge and don't access e-resources from the library. It is also clear from the table that a very small number of Indigenous students access e-journals, e-books, and different databases.

7.5 Types of Information Needed by the Indigenous PG Students

Table 5 depicts that most of the Indigenous postgraduate students are interested in information on Indigenous cultures and different schemes and scholarships for Indigenous. Only 15.22 % of students are interested in e-databases.

7.6 Recognize Different Types of Sources of Information

The significance of diverse information sources becomes evident only when users can utilize them with efficacy and efficiency. It is expected of students to be acquainted with and knowledgeable about methods of looking for information in this context. Table 6 depicts that Indigenous PG students (35.38 %) of Vidyasagar University can identify different types of potential information sources available on the web,

Table 2. Perceptions of digital skills proficiency across key areas

Statement	Strongly agree	%	Agree	%	Don't know	%	Disagree	%	Strongly disagree	%
Knowledge of the basics of computer applications and functions	165	71.74	45	19.57	20	8.70	0	0.00	0	0.00
Knowledge of Different search techniques to retrieve resources from the internet	50	21.74	67	29.13	55	23.91	20	8.70	38	16.52
Understanding of IP addresses, domain names, and URLs	48	20.87	46	20.00	78	33.91	30	13.04	28	12.17
Understanding how to defend data against digital threats and viruses	37	16.09	43	18.70	117	50.87	20	8.70	13	5.65
Familiarity with downloading and utilising applications on various electronic gadgets	59	25.65	109	47.39	20	8.70	22	9.57	20	8.70

Table 3. Knowledge of different search techniques

University	VU(N=65)		BKU(N=60)		SKBU(N=60)		KNU(N=45)	
Information searching techniques	Know	Don't Know	Know	Don't Know	Know	Don't Know	Know	Don't Know
Simple	65(100%)	0	60(100%)	0	60(100%)	0	45(100%)	0
Advanced	28(43.07%)	37(56.93%)	22(36.67%)	38(63.33%)	18(30%)	48(80%)	23(51.11%)	22(48.89%)
Field search (Title, URL, etc.)	31(47.69%)	34(52.31%)	22(36.67%)	38(63.33%)	23(33.33%)	37(61.67%)	25(55.56%)	20(44.44%)
Exact match	7(10.76%)	58(89.23%)	0	60(100%)	8(13.33%)	52(86.67%)	8(17.78%)	37(82.22%)
Truncation and wildcards	3(4.61%)	62(95.38%)	0	60(100%)	0	60(100%)	2(4.44%)	43(95.56%)
Using controlled vocabulary	0	65(100%)	0	60(100%)	0	60(100%)	0	45(100%)

whereas a smaller number of Indigenous PG students of Bankura University (15 %), Sidho-Kanho-Birsa University 18.33 % and Kazi Nazrul University (15.56 %) know of this. From the table, it is also clear that most of the students from the four universities don't have the knowledge to recognize different information sources.

7.7 Evaluation of Information available on the Web

A person who is information literate can always assess information. In the current age of rapid technological advancement and a wealth of information resources, information retrieval has grown increasingly challenging. To find and retrieve pertinent information in the best

Table 4. Kinds of electronic resources that the indigenous postgraduate students use from the library

Electronic resources accessed by the indigenous PG students in the library	VU	BKU	SKBU	KNU
E-journals	8	3	4	10
eBooks	7	2	5	15
E-thesis & dissertations	7	0	0	2
Full text databases	10	0	0	0
Bibliographic and citation databases	8	0	0	8
Institutional repositories	15	0	0	0
None of the above	10	55	51	10
Total no. of students (Samples)	**65**	**60**	**60**	**45**

Table 5. Type of information seeking by the indigenous PG students

Type of information	No. of respondents	Percentage
Educational	56	24.35
Searching E-databases	35	15.22
News	45	19.57
Entertainment	60	26.09
Social media	120	52.17
Travel	20	8.70
Indigenous cultures	130	56.52
Different indigenous schemes and scholarships for PG students	140	60.87

Table 6. Ability to identify different information sources

Statements	VU (N=65)	%	BKU (N=60)	%	SKBU (N=60)	%	KNU (N=45)	%	Total (N=230)	%
Capability to differentiate between different sources of information from the web and their importance	10	15.38	6	10.00	6	10.00	5	11.11	30	13.04
Ability to recognize the various kinds of possible Internet information sources	23	35.38	9	15.00	11	18.33	7	15.56	56	24.35
Ability to distinguish between the various online information sources that are available, such as scholarly or popular, current or historical, etc.	7	10.77	12	20.00	12	20.00	11	24.44	44	19.13
Ability to differentiate between e-journal, e-book, e-magazine, blogs, etc	7	10.77	15	25.00	14	23.33	15	33.33	35	15.22
Knowledge of utilizing more e-resources than printed sources of information	5	7.69	5	8.33	8	13.33	2	4.44	22	9.57
Lack of knowledge to identify sources of information from the web	13	20.00	13	21.67	9	15.00	5	11.11	43	18.70

and most efficient manner possible, an information user has to be informed about information evaluation. From Table 7, we see that 31.3 % of respondents evaluate information by the authority of the information sources. 39.13 % and 48.26 % of students evaluate information by the authenticity and currency of the information. 75.22 % of students used the usability criteria for the evaluation of information sources available on the internet.

8. FINDINGS

The study discussed above has the following primary findings.

- The majority of postgraduate Indigenous students recognize their information needs. From the table 5 we see that 24.35 % students seeks information about there study, education etc., 15.22 % students seek information about the searching of e-databases, 56.22 % students need information about their indigenous cultures, customs etc.
- Approximately 91.31 % of respondents know basic computer skills. However, the largest number of the respondents have inadequate knowledge about various search techniques for searching documents from the internet and knowledge of URLs.

Table 7. Evaluation of information

Evaluation of information available in web							
Usability	**Accessibility of information**	**Coverage**	**Currentness of information**	**Authenticity of information**	**Authority of information source available on the WEB**	**Criteria**	**Universities**
33	52	38	35	25	27	N	
						Follow	
50.77	80.00	58.46	53.85	38.46	41.54	%	**VU(N=65)**
32	13	27	30	40	38	N	
						Not Follow	
49.23	20.00	41.54	46.15	61.54	58.46	%	
27	48	34	25	22	13	N	
						Follow	
45.00	80.00	56.67	41.67	36.67	21.67	%	**BKU(N=60)**
33	12	26	35	38	47	N	
						Not Follow	
55.00	20.00	43.33	58.33	63.33	78.33	%	
27	35	35	23	18	14	N	
						Follow	
45.00	58.33	58.33	38.33	30.00	23.33	%	**SKBU(N=60)**
33	25	25	37	42	46	N	
						Not Follow	
75.00	97.22	97.22	63.89	50.00	38.89	%	
20	38	27	28	25	18	N	
						Follow	
44.44	84.44	60.00	62.22	55.56	40.00	%	**KNU(N=45)**
25	7	18	17	20	27	N	
						Not Follow	
55.56	15.56	40.00	37.78	44.44	60.00	%	
107	173	134	111	90	72	N	
						Follow	
46.52	75.22	58.26	48.26	39.13	31.30	%	**Total(N=230)**
123	57	96	119	140	158	N	
						Not Follow	
53.48	24.78	41.74	51.74	60.87	68.70	%	

- All of Indigenous students use 'simple search' or 'basic search' to retrieve documents from the internet. But in the case of different advanced search techniques above 50 % respondents are not aware about this. None of the respondents used controlled vocabulary for searching for information from the internet.
- The study also reveals that very few students search for e-resources from the library. From the Table 4 we see that students of VU are more aware of e-resources than the other three university students. Only 45.22 % of the total respondents are able to search e-resources.
- Only 13.04 % of respondents can differentiate different types of sources of information. 24.35 % of respondents can identify different potential sources of information. 15.22 % of respondents can differentiate between e-journals, e-books, blogs, e-magazines, etc.
- From the study we see that 75.22 % and 58.26 % of respondents evaluate digital information with their accessibility and coverage respectively. Only 31.3 % and 39.13 % of Indigenous postgraduate students evaluate information by their authority and authenticity.

9. CONCLUSIONS

This study elaborates on the elements of information literacy in using digital resources and/ or services of the Indigenous postgraduate students of the four universities. We see from the study that the efficiency of the use of digital information among Indigenous postgraduate students is not satisfactory. There is less evidence that students can use web-based services like Facebook, WhatsApp, and email for learning and research, despite their proficiency with the newest ICT technology for personal use. To help them use online information resources like online databases, digital libraries, open access e-books, e-journals, institutional repositories, and web portals more effectively for learning and research, it is therefore essential to train them in the fundamental and cognitive digital literacy skills besides the model curriculum. Academic libraries should therefore make sure that the educational system is maintained such a way that indigenous students' literacy levels are raised, and that national development is promoted. The library should support research and development as a means of obtaining and sharing information with the normal students as well as indigenous students. A country's human capital development will be vibrant if its library's role in creating a sustainable educational system and promoting information literacy among its citizens is recognised. The indigenous student's literacy level would improve as a result of the library's active involvement in the University's educational system. Also, this type of studies is needed for future research possibilities.

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